

any disruption in their manufacturing processes. A certain level of support can be extended from a distance enabled with more adoption of automation, which we see propelling the Indian economy.

The government is giving extra focus to sectors such as infrastructure development and technology, integral for enhancing industry production capacity across industry sectors. What is the optimal way to leverage this boom?

Infrastructure has got to play a very strong role in the Indian economy for fuelling growth and hence it is definitely one of the major focus sectors for the Government of India. The kind of consumption by the humongous population that one gets to see, the growth trajectory in various key sectors such as roads which in recent years was worth \$ 40 million, and the railways was to the tune of \$ 20 million would double to \$ 80 million and \$ 40 million respectively, in the next decade. Apart from this more spending would be pumped into 100 odd smart cities, aspirational districts, other peripheral towns and rural areas for creating economic zones. We see Delta in the thick of these development goals playing a key role of solutions provider in the automation segment such as waste water treatment plants, HVAC, chillers, airports, railways and metros. We also have equipment to support smoke ventilation fans for tunnels. The scope is endless for Delta as there will be a lot of growth across cities for accelerating the aspirations of industries. The investments that have come in are more for infrastructure in key areas which will improve the self-sustainability growth. Hi-tech technology is predominant in the product portfolio of suppliers, as well as its work stations and factory area, where processes or machines, everything is connected with multiple sensors.

Government is also focusing on clean energy, renewable energy and solar energy. How committed is Delta to the greener way to do business?

Delta's corporate mission focuses on clean energy and efficiency solutions to reduce carbon footprint. We are also part of the RE100, and our global operations will be achieving this target by 2030, coinciding with the SDG deadline. Delta has been deploying smart energy practices for years in power and solar inverters. Over the decades all our products have been designed for energy efficiency and would probably have saved billions

of kilowatt hours i.e., energy and also reduced multi-million tonnes of carbon emission. Delta Group stands committed to renewable energy, and we are investing in new technologies. We also see renewable as the core of our growth in future automation and beyond automation viz-a-viz our other businesses. All our offices are energy efficient and certified green buildings and so will be the new investments in R&D set-ups and factories that are coming up in India.

The government has made a lot of investments and provided many schemes aimed at encouraging the private sector. What have been the major gains from these steps?

Electronic automation is driven by our power electronic strength. The government schemes have attracted more investments from us in our global factory based in India where we will be manufacturing Delta products for export to SE Asia, Europe, Africa and the US. The Production Linked Incentive Scheme (PLI) for Large Scale Electronics Manufacturing helps us in manufacturing at its core. India is a leading electronic exporter, strong in telecom, has huge automobile, textile, food processing and healthcare sectors attracting foreign funding and are being promoted prominently, so all these sectors per se means automation and we have presence in all of them as partners for systems solution or the complete factory line. The investments through the PLI and FDIs will boost the over-all demand for automation across the industries for us in the coming years.

Skilled human resources is of paramount importance to run the show. What is the right way to strategize this very important aspect?

Unless you have strong human resources, which is an indispensable asset, any amount of ambitious plans would not work. Whether it's the core expertise or in terms of the factory manpower, we are well placed. As an organization, Delta has been very particular in bringing in young engineers in-house, train them, retain them and then bring them into different job skills. We also from time-to-time look into focus sectors from where we try and gain expertise. Resources are also invested in our well-versed, trained manpower or who are adept to look at the core focus areas.

In the new normal, after the Covid, the way businesses are being conducted has changed. In this backdrop what are the new opportunities to be explored?

Covid definitely has compelled us to explore new ways of working and today we are working from home or in a hybrid manner, something that we could not have imagined a few years ago. And there is definitely no gap in the deliverables and that is true for us. Even for the application of technical strength, we do a lot of things online through a lot of connectivity through cloud. IoT has given the industry more connectivity such as remote monitoring services which really got expedited during the lockdown where we even commissioned machines online. We are also gaining in the software space which is very important in the operational segment, IT and linking etc. Delta has been into smart manufacturing for years where we get a lot of data to analyse and make use of in our future processes. We are also looking at introducing new technologies and products in the fresh segment. Energy efficiency, clean energy and energy saving has been our core focus in going ahead and so everything is aligned with our corporate mission.

What are the advantages that you see by investing in India?

India is much more politically stable as a country, and with a lot of schemes coming up there is seriousness on the part of government to accomplish the Make in India vision.

We are investing aggressively in India which is our core market. Recently this year, India was brought in as a separate region altogether within the Delta Group with more focus and intention because India is recognised as a big market.

The Delta Corporate is looking at India as a manufacturing hub with our various plants including our largest plant at Krishnagiri and there is a very strong line-up of products that would soon be manufactured here aided by our R&D labs in Bengaluru. Here we will employ thousands of engineers in our company over a few years through campus interviews and hire highly skilled people. In the factory, we will need thousands of ITI and Polytechnic trained youngsters.

Overall scenario is very optimistic, a sentiment which is palpable in the market also. The need and aspirations of the customers keep changing and we as a technology company need to be adaptable, flexible, and anticipate what is going to be there in the next five years and develop a robust set of customised portfolios alongside. Delta invests 8 percent of its revenues in R&D to ensure innovation and new developments, which is the core of our philosophy.